



University Quality Assurance

University: LIU

Faculty: Education

Department: English

Course Specifications

Program(s) on which the course is given: Undergraduate

Major or minor element of programs: Thesis & Non-Thesis Programs

Department offering the program: English

Department offering the course: English

Academic year: 2018-2019

Semester: **SPRING**

Section: _____

Rm# _____

Date of specification approval (faculty council): 2002

A- Basic Information

Title: Communication Skills

Code: ENGL 251

Credit Hours: 3 cr.

Lecture/Week: Twice – MW or TTh

Tutorial/Week: NA

Practical/ Week: 2

Duration (No. of weeks): 15-16 Weeks

Names of lecturers contributing in the course: Yaacoub M. Hammoud (Course Coordinator);
LIU/BIU ENGL251 Teams

B- Professional Information

1- Overall Aims of Course

ENGL251 is a workplace occupational writing course that is designed to help undergraduate students of all majors develop skills and experience to function in the non-academic world of communication, where private sector businesses and public sector institutions and agencies are in an incessant struggle to find competent workplace writers. Hence, ENGL251 or *Communication Skills* is an advanced interdisciplinary writing course that emphasizes workplace and technical communication appropriate to diverse professions. It incorporates practice and study of selected types of discourse employed in professional writing situations, thereby preparing students for different systems of writing in their professional lives. Examples from the writing of workplace professionals are analyzed and used as models to demonstrate the transition from academic to professional writing.

2- Intended Learning Outcomes of Course (ILOs)

A- Knowledge and understanding

A1: Recognize a myriad of current issues (corporate ethics, web etiquette, cultural diversity, etc.) that impact business communication

A2: Demonstrate mastery of standard grammar and writing mechanics

B- Intellectual skills

B1: Analyze and evaluate audience/purpose/situation

B2: Read and critically analyze the writings of various business professions

C- Professional and practical skills

C1: Avoid plagiarism

C2: Be able to give and receive constructive feedback among peers

C3: Plan, draft, revise, and edit business writing

C4: Use current technology to design accurate and visually appealing

PowerPoint slides that will maximize the effectiveness of written and oral reports

D- General and transferable skills

D1: Communicate across cultures

D2: Develop clear, concise, persuasive, ethical, effective business rhetoric

D3: Actively plan and participate in a collaborative project

D4: Critically investigate and use a variety of research tools

3- Contents: **SPRING 2018-19** ENGL251 Teaching Schedule

WEEK	CHAPTER(S) / TOPIC(S) / SKILL(S)	CW / HW / Quizzes / Tests	COMMENT(S)
1	- Course Orientation	- Writing diagnostic paper*	General: - All HW assignments must be typed. - Course book must be obtained as of the first session. – 2 Quizzes per semester: One before the Midterm Exam and the other after the Midterm Exam. * Content Specific (CS): Diagnostic paper requests response to a paragraph or essay prompt that the instructor provides. Student papers are <u>not scored</u> . Holistic comments are shared with students, however. The papers are <u>archived</u> by the instructor for one semester.
	- Chapter 3: Collaborative Writing & Meetings at Work*	Collaborative CW: ex.1, article C (writing a brief report) Connect-to-Workplace CW: Employed students (or Instructors) get samples of Meeting Minutes from their workplaces, share samples with colleagues during session, glean insights, and share feedback and suggestions for further improvement of the scrutinized Meeting Minutes samples.	* CS: Emphasis must be laid on “Sources of Conflict in Collaborative Groups & How to Solve Them”, “Models for Collaboration”, “Types of Groupware”, Agenda and Meeting Minutes
2	Chapter 3: Collaborative Writing & Meetings at Work (Cont’d)		
3	- Chapter 4: Writing Routine Business Correspondence (Memos, Faxes, E-Mails, IMs, & Blogs)*	Individual CW: ex. 5 (composing a memo) Connect-to-Workplace CW: Employed students (or Instructors) get sample emails (and, if possible, sample faxes) from their workplaces. Students share samples with colleagues during session, collaboratively glean insights, and share feedback and suggestions for further improvement & 8 (evaluating email samples)	* CS: Figures 4.1, 4.2, & 4.3 are three examples of the three organizational markers for writing memos and emails
		HW #1: ex. 1 (writing a memo) HW #2: ex. 11 (sending an email)**	** CS: Students respond to the prompt in email form to be sent Instructor

4	Chapter 4: Writing Routine Business Correspondence (Memos, Faxes, E-Mails, IMs, & Blogs) (Cont'd)	Individual CW: ex. 18 (writing an external blog); HW #3: ex. 17 (collaborative instant messaging) HW #4: ex. 19 (writing an internal blog)*	* CS: The following are further suggested topics for internal blog posts. - Is Social Media Making Us Dumb? - Is Your Kindness Viewed as Weakness? - Are You a Leader, or Just Pretending to Be One?
→ Quiz #1: Chapters 3 & 4 ←			
5	- Chapter 5: Writing Letters (Some Basics for Audiences Worldwide)*	Connect-to-Workplace CW: ex. 1 Employed students get sample business letters from their workplaces. Students share samples with colleagues during session, glean insights, and share feedback and suggestions for further improvement Collaborative CW: ex. 3 (correcting inside addresses), 6 (applying You-Attitude), 7 (eliminating legalese), & 9 article a (revising an international business letter) HW #5: ex. 8 (writing a business letter)	* CS: Emphasis must be laid on “Letter Formats”, “You Attitude”, principles of “International Business correspondence”, & the CASE STUDY “Writing to a Client from a Different Culture”.
6	- Chapter 6 (Part 1): Types of Business Letters: <i>Inquiry, Special Request, Cover, & Sales Letters</i>	HW #6: ex. 1 (writing an inquiry letter) HW #7: ex. 2 (writing a special request letter) Core HW #8: Write a cover letter* to be attached to résumé later on	* CS: Cover Letter has its own weightage and is an integral part of HW grand score. ** CS: Question 4 (Sales Letter) has its own weightage and is an integral part of HW grand score.
7	Chapter 6 (Part 1): Types of Business Letters: <i>Inquiry, Special Request, Cover, & Sales Letters (Cont'd)</i>	Collaborative CW: ex. 6 (revising a sales letter) Core HW #9: ex. 4 (writing a sales letter)**	
8	Midterm Exam*: Date TBA		* CS: Midterm Exam: - Required Chapters for Midterm Exam: 3, 4, 5 - Excluded from Midterm Exam: Chapter 6 (Part 1)
9	Chapter 6: Types of Business Letters (Part 2): <i>Customer Relations Letters (Good/Bad News Letters; Follow-Up, Complaint, & Adjustment Letters*)</i>	Collaborative CW: ex. 16 (revising a complaint letter) HW #10: ex. 8 (writing a follow-up letter) HW #11: ex. 12 (writing a complaint letter)	* CS: Complaint Letter & Adjustment Yes/No Letter sections of this chapter are integral parts of Final Exam General: Revision of Midterm student responses

10	Chapter 6: Types of Business Letters (Part 2): <i>Customer Relations Letters (Good/Bad News Letters; Follow-Up, Complaint, & Adjustment Letters) (Cont'd)</i>	Collaborative CW: ex. 20 (revising a Yes Adjustment Letter), & 21 (revising a No Adjustment Letter)	
	→ Quiz #2: Chapter 6 (Part 2) ←		
11	- Chapter 13: Writing Winning Proposals (<i>Internal & External/Sales Proposals</i>)		Sales Proposal (in response to Question 4 of this chapter or prompts that Instructor provides or student suggests) is to be produced by students collaboratively (in pairs or groups) and has its own weightage, as it is the PROJECT paper that is due not later than Week 14.
12	Chapter 13: Writing Winning Proposals (<i>Internal & External/Sales Proposals</i>) (Cont'd)	Collaborative HW: ex. 3 'internal proposal' (Optional); ex. 4 'external proposal' (Obligatory)*	
13	- Chapter 7: How to Get a Job ([<i>Job</i>] Searches, <i>Dossiers, Portfolios*</i> , <i>Résumés**</i> , <i>Letters [Application, Follow-Up, Accepting/Declining a Job Offer]</i> , & <i>Interviews</i>)	Collaborative CW: ex. 2 (identifying résumé parts), 4 (revising a résumé) Core HW #12: ex. 8 (writing a chronologically organized résumé) or 9 (writing a functional résumé) + Submit Cover letter (of Week 7) along with it (if student has not yet)	General: This week Instructor emails students a sample student portfolio for students to produce their own similar ones and earn the bonus marks Instructor would allot to duly submission of the <i>complete</i> portfolio. * CS: Students who have developed a career portfolio may like to share a sample of it with the rest of class. ** CS: Résumé (in response to Question 8 or 9 of this chapter) is to be produced by students individually and has its own weightage, as it is an integral part of HW grand score.
14	Chapter 7: How to Get a Job (<i>Résumés, Letters [Application*, Follow-Up, Accepting/Declining a Job Offer]</i> , & <i>Interviews</i>) (Cont'd)	Collaborative CW: ex. 5 (eliminating application letter mistakes) HW #13: ex. 6 (revising an application letter) or 7 (writing an application letter)	General: (External) Sales Proposal is DUE this week. * CS: Distinction should be made between Letter of Application & Résumé, as well as Letter of Application & Cover Letter.
15	Sales Proposal PPT Presentations Reference for Student: Chapter 16 (Appendix) – The PPT sample (16.2) can serve as good sales proposal PPT presentation model Reference for Instructor: Evaluation Form (Figure 16.3) is the tool the instructor uses to evaluate student's PPT presentation.		General: Student Portfolio is DUE this week.
16	Final Exam*: Date TBA		* CS: Final Exam: - Required Chapters for the Final Exam: 6 (Part 2), 13, 7 - Excluded from the test: Chapters 16 & 2 (as these two are only appendices)

4- Teaching and Learning Methods

4.1: Lectures

4.2: Presentations

4.3: Group Discussions

4.4: Writings (Case Studies, Projects, Collaborative Writing Groups, Homework, Classwork)

5- Student Assessment Methods

5.1: Discussion and description of introduced business writing skills to assess student assimilation of the taught content

5.2: Oral and written reflections to assess application/practical skills

5.3: Presentations of Sales Proposal papers to assess business communication skills

5.4: Business Letters, Résumé, and Sales Proposal production to assess creativity and innovation

Assessment Schedule

Assessment 1: Quiz #1: Week 4 / Quiz #2: Week 10

Assessment 2: HW (Cover letter, Résumé, and Sales Letter as core or integral pieces, along with the rest of HW assignments that the above schedule specifies)

Assessment 3: Individual and Collaborative CW (where applicable)

Assessment 3: Midterm Exam: Week 8

Assessment 4: Sales Proposal (Project): Week 14

Assessment 5: PPT Presentations: Week 15

Assessment 6: Final Exam: Week 16

Weightage of Formative and Summative Assessments

Midterm Exam	25 %
Final Exam	25 %
Practical Examination (Sales Proposal)	10 %
Oral Examination (PPT Presentation)	10 %
Class Work	10 %
HW Assignments (Core HW in specific)	10 %
Quizzes	10 %
Total	100 %

6- List of References

6.1- Essential book (Textbook)

SUCCESSFUL WRITING AT WORK (Philip C. Kolin)

Publisher: Wadsworth / Cengage Learning – Ninth Edition, 2010

ISBN- 13: 978-0-547-14791-8

COURSE PREREQUISITE: ENGL201

7- Facilities Required for Teaching and Learning

LCD Projector / Audio-Visual Devices / E-mail Correspondence / Office Meetings

Course Coordinator: Yaacoub M. Hammoud

Dean of SoED: Dr. Anwar Kawtharani

Date: February 11, 2019